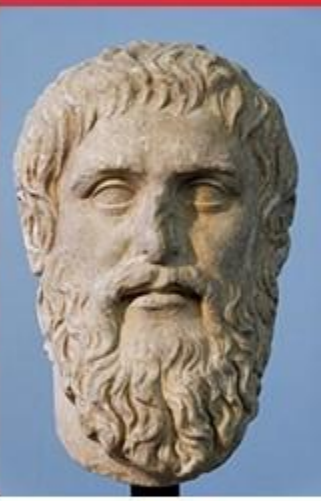
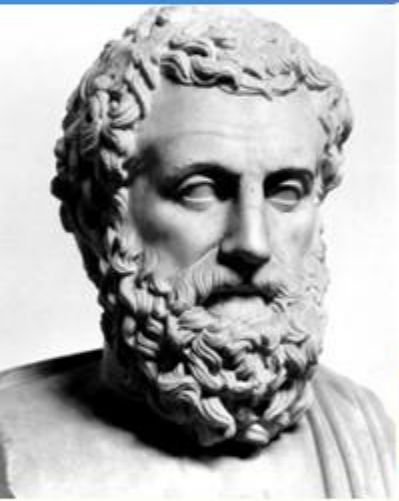


ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE



MODULE - 3

**NATURE & SCOPE
OF ETHICS**

NORMATIVE ETHICS

EXAMPLE



Lord Krishna exhorting a distressed Arjuna to perform his duty as a warrior.

NORMATIVE

- 1 Moral norms are **standards** or **principles** with which people are expected to **comply**.
- 2 Norms are **sentences (rules)** that aim to affect an action, rather than theoretical concepts which just describe, explain and express.
- 3 Normative sentences include **commands, permissions and prohibitions**, while common theoretical concepts include **sincerity, justification, and honesty**.

'Normative' comes from the word **'norm'**, which means a **'standard'**, or a **'rule'**.

NORMATIVE ETHICS



The Golden Rule from the Bible

- 4 Normative or **prescriptive ethics** studies the issue of how we **ought to live and act**.
- 5 Normative ethics articulates and advocates an **ethical code**, i.e., to provide justifiable and reliable principles to determine what is moral (and immoral) behavior.
- 6 The **Golden Rule from the Bible**, '**do as you would be done by**' is another example of a normative theory that prescribes a single principle against which we judge all our actions.

THEORIES IN NORMATIVE ETHICS

VIRTUE



A character a human being needs to flourish or live well.

DUTY



Which you ought to do it because it is your responsibility.

TELEOLOGICAL



Related to the view that certain phenomena are best explained in terms of purpose rather than cause.

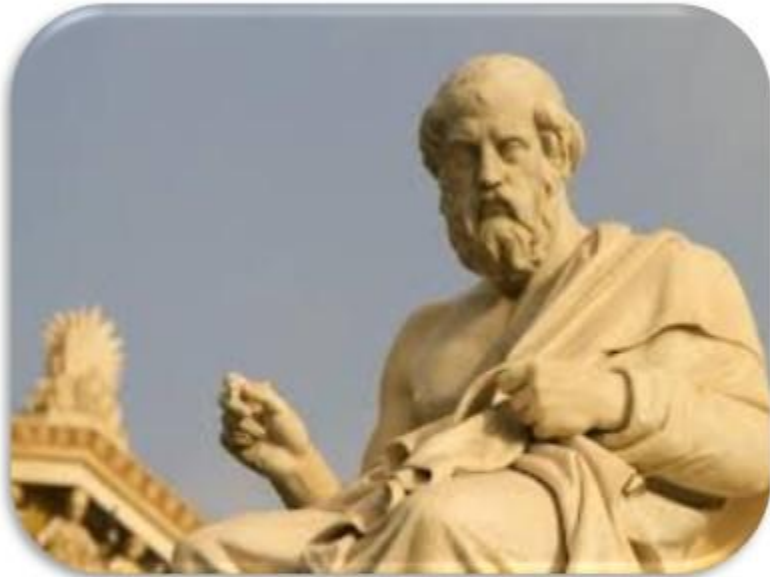
VIRTUE ETHICS



- 1 It is a common belief that morality consists of following precisely defined rules of conduct, such as "don't kill," or "don't steal."
- 2 But **Virtue ethics** places less emphasis on learning rules, and instead stresses the importance of **developing good habits of character** (such as kindness).
- 3 It is concerned with **building good personality or character** by creating traits and habits toward acting with justice, prudence, courage, restraint, compassion, wisdom, and determination.

VIRTUE ETHICS

PLATO



Emphasized four virtues called cardinal virtues:
wisdom, courage, temperance and justice.

Temperance: control of one's own behaviour, such as not drinking or eating too much.

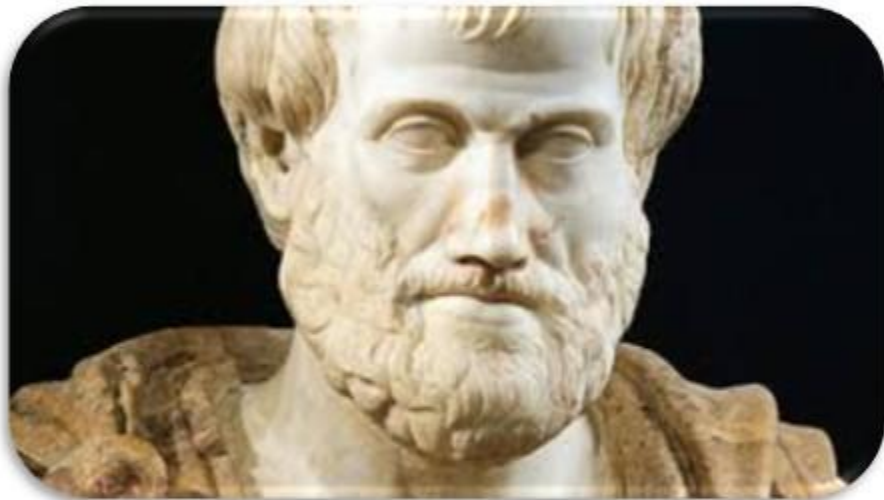
4 Once these traits are acquired, the person is expected to act in a manner incorporating those characteristics.

5 Some important **virtues** are **fortitude, generosity, self-respect, good temper, and sincerity.**

6 Virtue theorists also hold that we should **avoid acquiring bad character traits, or vices**, such as cowardice, insensibility, injustice, and vanity (taking great pride in one's abilities or appearance).

VIRTUE THEORIES

ARISTOTLE



Aristotle's two principal virtues are **theoretical wisdom** and **practical wisdom**.

7 Virtue theory **emphasizes moral education** since virtuous character traits are developed in one's youth. Adults, therefore, are deemed responsible for instilling virtues in the young.

8 The character (model of practical reasoning) is built by answering the question "**what habits should I develop?**"

9 In overall, the creation of personal identity is achieved by **combining desires, reason and character habits**.

DUTY THEORIES

EXAMPLES



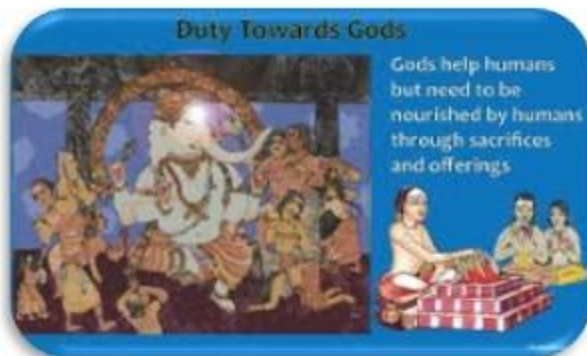
It is wrong not to care for our children even at significant financial cost and it is wrong to commit murder.

1 It is also called as **deontological theory**, which is the ethical theory based on **duties, obligations and rights**.

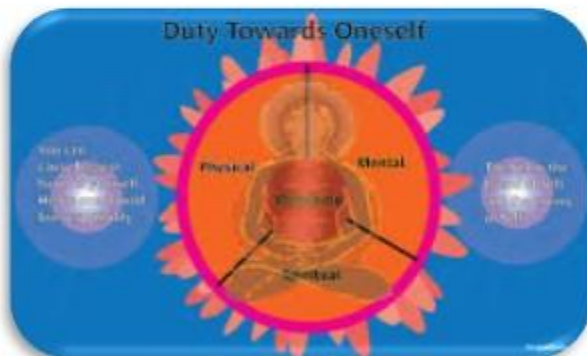
2 Duty theories base morality on specific, foundational **principles of obligation** as many of us feel that there are clear obligations we have as human beings,

3 The theories are also called **nonconsequentialist** since these principles are obligatory, **irrespective of the consequences** that might follow from our actions.

DUTY THEORIES



DUTY TO GOD



DUTY TO ONESELF



DUTY TO OTHERS

4 The first theory was championed by German philosopher Samuel Pufendorf. He classified dozens of duties under three headings: **duties to God**, **duties to oneself**, and **duties to others**.

5 A second duty-based approach to ethics, championed by British philosopher John Locke, is **rights theory**. A "**right**" is a **justified claim** against another person's behavior - such as my right to not be deceived or even killed by you.

*Hinduism prescribes **Dharma**, which is same as **Duty**.*

DUTY THEORIES

KANTISM



Universality



Reciprocity

6 A third duty-based theory by Immanuel Kant emphasizes a single principle of duty. He agreed that we have moral duties to oneself and others, such as developing one's talents, and keeping our promises to others.

7 He stated that the consequences of an act of willing cannot be used to determine that the person has a good will or not.

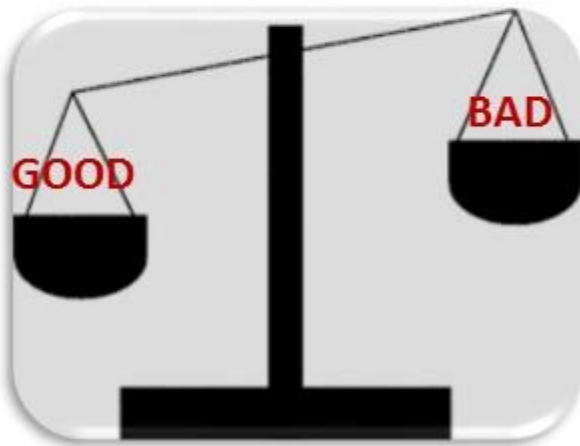
8 Moral rules should follow two principles: universality – a moral action is possible to be applied to all people; and reciprocity – like the Golden Rule.

His theory is widely known as **Kantism** or **Categorical Imperative**

CONSEQUENTIALIST ETHICS



Tally good and
bad and
choose



Moral action

- 1 It is also called **teleological ethics** and says that an action is morally **right** if the **consequences** of that action **are more favorable** than unfavorable.
- 2 Consequentialist normative principles require that we first **tally both the good and bad consequences** of an action. Second, we **then determine** whether the total good consequences outweigh the total bad consequences.
- 3 If the **good consequences** are greater, then the action is **morally proper**. If the **bad consequences** are greater, then the action is **morally improper**.

'End justifies the means'

CONSEQUENTIALIST THEORIES

**EGOISM?**

US Shutdown
on the Mexico
Wall issue

**ALTRUISM**

Volunteering to
teach slum
children

**UTILITARIANISM**

Judge pardoning a
convict pardoned by
the victim's family

1 Egoism: an action is morally right if the consequences of that action are more favorable than unfavorable only to the agent performing the action.

2 Altruism: an action is morally right if the consequences of that action are more favorable than unfavorable to everyone except the agent.

3 Utilitarianism: an action is morally right if the consequences of that action are more favorable than unfavorable to everyone.

'End justifies the means'

APPLIED ETHICS

SARDAR
SAROVAR DAMEnvironmental
Ethics

TATA GROUP

Business
Ethics

- 1 It is devoted to the treatment of moral problems, practices, and policies in **personal life, professions, technology, and government.**
- 2 Applied ethics refers to the **practical application** of moral considerations as opposed to the theoretical aspects of other branches of ethics.
- 3 **Two features** are necessary for an issue to be considered an "applied ethical issue." **One:** the issue needs to be **controversial** in the sense that there are significant groups of people both for and against the issue at hand.

APPLIED ETHICS



Underpaid labour



Child labour

4 Two: The issue under scanner must be a **distinctly moral** issue.

5 There are several rival normative principles from which to choose, and many of them yield opposite conclusions to the applied ethical issue.

6 Thus, the conflicting theories of normative ethics prevent us from using a single decisive procedure for determining the morality of a specific issue. There would be **multiple choices to choose from**.



APPLIED ETHICS



CHERNOBYL ACCIDENT

VARANASI FLYOVER
COLLAPSEENGINEERING
ETHICS

- 1 **Business ethics:** Corporate Social Responsibility, MNCs manufacturing their goods in countries that employ child or underpaid labour, venturing into gray areas to increase profitability
- 2 **Bio ethics:** Abortion, Euthanasia, Access to or lack of quality healthcare
- 3 **Professional ethics:** Journalistic ethics, Public Servants, Leaders, Doctors, Engineers
- 4 **Moral standing and personhood:** Assigning moral standing to others such as animals, foetus, aliens etc.,

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